

2026

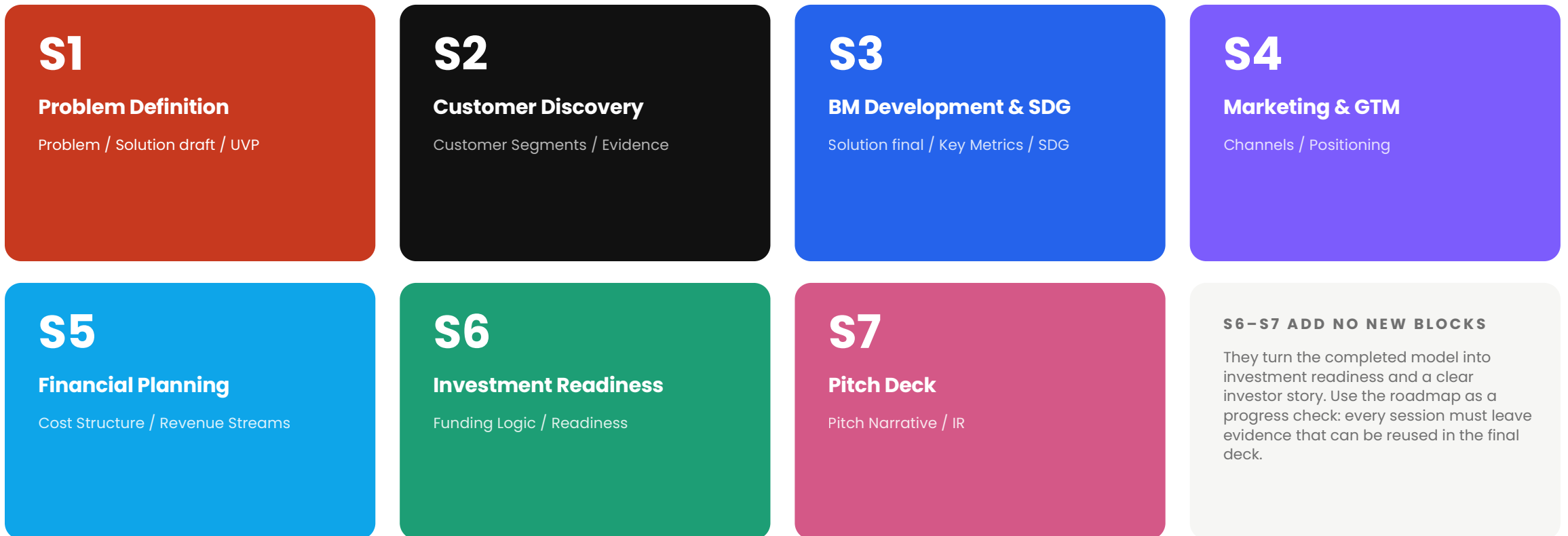
NIGERIA PMC CUSTOMER DISCOVERY

Customer Discovery · **Session 2**

KOICA PMC

Seven Sessions Build One Business Model

S1–S5 complete the 9 blocks. S6–S7 turn the model into investment readiness and investor communication.



9 BLOCKS BUILT
ACROSS S1–S5

Problem

Solution

UVP

Segments

Metrics

Channels

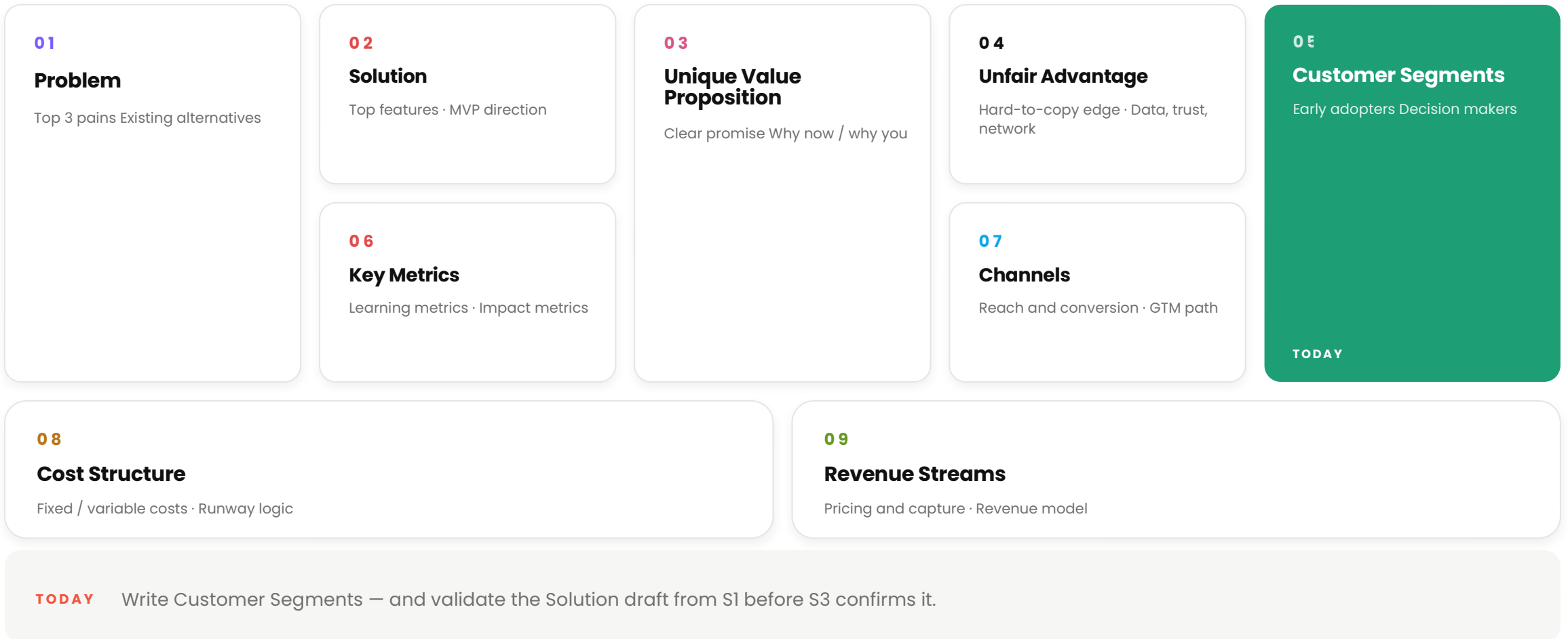
Costs

Revenue

Advantage

Lean Canvas Build Map

S1–S5 complete the 9 blocks. S6–S7 translate the completed model into investor communication.



What This Session Produces

Every session leaves participants with a usable BM artifact.

LESSON GOAL **Validate whether real customers feel the pain strongly enough to change behavior.**

01

Customer Segment

Define the first group to validate.

This narrows the market into a group the team can actually reach.

02

Persona

Turn a segment into a specific person.

This makes the customer concrete enough to interview and design for.

03

Interview Guide

Ask about behavior, not opinions.

This turns discovery into behavior-based evidence collection.

04

Evidence Review

Decide whether the hypothesis changes.

This forces a decision: proceed, narrow, pivot, or reject.

PART 1

Customer Before Market Size

Segments come before TAM.

Customers Are Not Abstract Markets

You cannot interview TAM; you interview specific people.

RISK

Market

Large opportunity, useful later for investors.

BETTER DIRECTION

Segment

Specific group with a repeated job and pain.

A Useful Segment Is Narrow

Narrow does not mean small forever.

01

Same Job

They try to get similar work done.

02

Same Pain

They experience similar friction.

03

Reachable

You can find and interview them.

04

Early Adopter

They feel the pain before others.

Define the First Segment

Write the segment so it can be found.

[Who] in **[context]** who need to **[job]** but struggle with **[pain]**.

01

Who

Role or group

02

Context

Place or industry

03

Job

What they need done

04

Pain

What blocks progress

Persona Makes the Segment Real

A persona is a decision tool, not decoration.

01

Role

What job or responsibility do they hold?

02

Context

Where does the pain happen?

03

Workflow

How do they solve it today?

04

Motivation

What outcome do they care about?

Persona Example: Market Vendor

Use a realistic customer, not a generic profile.

CASE STUDY

Market Vendor

Read the case as a decision: what pain was real, what evidence mattered, and what can transfer to the team's own model?

01 Who

Small textile vendor in Lagos who sells through walk-in customers, WhatsApp referrals, and informal repeat buyers.

02 Job

Accept payments, confirm transfers, track daily sales, and avoid losing orders when cash or bank transfer fails.

03 Pain

Manual records, delayed transfer confirmation, and payment uncertainty create stress and lost time during busy sales hours.

04 Signal

Already uses a POS agent, bank app, notebook, or WhatsApp proof-of-payment workaround; the workaround shows the pain is active.

Persona Example: Urban SME Owner

Specific personas make better interviews.

CASE STUDY

Urban SME Owner

Read the case as a decision: what pain was real, what evidence mattered, and what can transfer to the team's own model?

01 Who

Cold-room, salon, or small service-business owner whose revenue depends on reliable electricity and equipment uptime.

02 Job

Keep service running, protect equipment, manage fuel spend, and avoid disappointing customers during outages.

03 Pain

Fuel cost, downtime, equipment risk, and unpredictable operating expense make growth harder to plan.

04 Signal

Already pays for generator fuel, backup service, repairs, or informal power solutions; paid workaround indicates urgent pain.

Use Local Behavior as Discovery Evidence

For each persona, connect the visible situation to the exact question that reveals real behavior.

01 Market Vendor

Persona / situation: daily cash flow, POS dependency, payment uncertainty, ledger habits, trust boundaries.

ASK THIS

Walk me through yesterday's sales and payment collection. Where did money get delayed or go missing?

02 Urban SME Owner

Persona / situation: generator fuel spend, downtime routines, staff coordination, supplier payments, emergency workarounds.

ASK THIS

What happened the last time power or payment failure interrupted sales? Who fixed it, and what did it cost?

03 Developer / Merchant Operator

Persona / situation: developers reveal integration friction while merchants reveal revenue pain and failed transactions.

ASK THIS

Show where the technical workflow fails and what business consequence follows for the merchant.

04 Hospital / Logistics Operator

Persona / situation: urgency, reliability, escalation path, buyer approval, and cost of failure.

ASK THIS

What delay, risk, or stockout creates the most serious consequence? Who must approve the fix?

Turn Broad Markets Into Interviewable Segments

A segment is useful only when the team knows what behavior or pain to investigate first.

01 Traditional Fabric Vendors

Not "retail SMEs" in general. Start with fabric and clothing vendors who sell through walk-ins, WhatsApp referrals, and repeat buyers.

DISCOVERY FOCUS

payment confirmation, inventory pressure, trust, daily sales records, repeat customer behavior

02 Solar Micro-Energy SMEs

Not "energy users" in general. Start with cold-room, salon, kiosk, or service SMEs whose revenue drops when power fails.

DISCOVERY FOCUS

generator spend, downtime frequency, repair cost, customer loss, willingness to pay for reliability

03 Developer-Merchant Pair

For payment infrastructure, the developer feels integration friction while the merchant feels revenue loss. Interview both.

DISCOVERY FOCUS

technical workflow failure, failed payment consequence, settlement delay, merchant support burden

04 Hospital Logistics Operator

For medical logistics, the buyer, operator, and beneficiary may be different people. Separate them before defining the segment.

DISCOVERY FOCUS

who requests supply, who approves cost, who handles delay, what failure costs

Hypothesis → Interview → Customer Proof → Decision

Discovery is a decision gate: keep, revise, or drop the model based on customer proof.

01

Hypothesis

Who has the pain? How often does it happen? What consequence makes it worth solving?

02

Interview

Ask for last time, current workaround, money/time lost, decision maker, and switching barrier.

03

Customer Proof

Look for repeated pain, paid workaround, observed workflow, referral, payment, or commitment.

04

Decision

Proceed, narrow, pivot problem, or pivot segment based on what customers actually prove.

IF PROVED

Keep the segment and build the smallest MVP / Product test that can prove behavior.

IF NOT PROVED

Rewrite the hypothesis, narrow the segment, or search for stronger pain.

MUST ASK Last occurrence, current workaround, cost of failure, buyer/user/operator split, and proof of commitment.

Paid Workarounds Are Strong Discovery Signals

Spending behavior is stronger than polite interest because it shows the pain already has economic weight.

01 Paid Consultant / Staff

If the customer already pays a person to solve, coordinate, or recover from the pain, the problem has a budget signal.

ASK What role is being paid, what failure do they prevent, and what would happen if that person disappeared?

02 Paid Software

A subscription proves willingness to pay, but the team must ask why the current tool is still insufficient.

ASK Which workflow is missing, what workaround remains, and what switching barrier keeps them there?

03 Spreadsheet / Notebook

Manual tracking means the pain exists even if no software has been purchased yet. The columns reveal what the customer measures.

ASK What do you track every day, what gets reconciled, and what mistake costs money?

04 Doing Nothing

No workaround does not always mean no pain. It may mean the pain is hidden, not owned, or not urgent enough yet.

ASK Who feels the consequence, who owns the budget, and what would make the pain urgent?

Customers Hire Solutions for Jobs

Understand the progress they seek.

01

Functional

What task must be completed?

02

Emotional

What stress must be reduced?

03

Social

What reputation or trust matters?

04

Economic

What cost or revenue is affected?

PART 2

Interview for Evidence

Listen for behavior, not compliments.

CUSTOMER SEGMENT · PERSONA

CUSTOMER INSIGHT DEVELOPMENT

Customer Interview

You Are a Researcher, Not a Salesperson

Do not pitch before you understand the workflow.

RISK

Bad Interview

Would you use this? What features do you want?

BETTER DIRECTION

Good Interview

How do you solve this today? What happened last time?

Who Should You Talk To?

Start accessible, but avoid politeness bias.

01

Current Users

People already living the problem.

02

Workaround Users

People paying or improvising today.

03

Decision Makers

People who approve spending.

04

Operators

People who feel the daily pain.

Ask About the Past and Present

Future intent is usually weak evidence.

01

Workflow

Walk me through how you do it today.

02

Trigger

When does the problem happen?

03

Impact

What happens if it is not solved?

04

Workaround

What do you use now?

05

Cost

What time or money does this consume?

06

Referral

Who else has this problem?

Questions That Create Fake Signal

These questions create compliments, imagined behavior, or politeness bias. Replace them with past-behavior questions.

01

Would you use it?

Too easy to say yes.

ASK INSTEAD

Tell me the last time you tried to solve this problem.

02

Do you like this idea?

Triggers politeness bias.

ASK INSTEAD

What part of this workflow already costs time, money, or trust?

03

What features do you want?

Users are experts in pain, not design.

ASK INSTEAD

What are you doing today, and where does it break?

04

How much would you pay?

Weak before pain and current spending are confirmed.

ASK INSTEAD

What do you already pay for, and why is it still not enough?

RULE Ask about what happened, what they paid, what they tried, and what failed. Do not ask them to imagine the future.

Seeing Beats Hearing

Watch the current workaround when possible.

01

Spreadsheet

Messy sheets show workflow pain.

02

WhatsApp Thread

Chat history reveals coordination cost.

03

Paper Ledger

Manual records reveal trust and tracking gaps.

04

Cash Flow

Payment behavior reveals economic urgency.

PART 3

Evidence and Decision

Do not collect interviews; interpret them.

Turn Interviews Into Signals

Use a simple evidence discipline after each interview.

01

Confirmed

The problem exists and is costly.

02

Weakened

Pain exists but urgency is low.

03

Changed

The real problem differs from the hypothesis.

04

Rejected

The segment does not feel the pain.

Evidence Should Lead to a Specific Model Decision

After interviews, interpret the pattern first, then choose the action that matches the evidence.

01 Interview Evidence

Capture repeated pain, workaround, cost, buyer role, urgency, and commitment.

IF PAIN IS STRONG

Proceed & Keep

Keep the segment. Build the smallest MVP / Product test that proves usage, payment, LOI, or repeated behavior.

Case: payment acceptance API for merchants with failed transactions.

IF PAIN IS WEAK

Narrow Target

Do not force the idea. Find a subgroup with higher frequency, cost, consequence, or urgency.

Case: focus on vendors with daily payment reconciliation pain.

IF PAIN IS DIFFERENT

Pivot Problem

Keep useful evidence, but rewrite the problem and UVP around the pain customers actually repeat.

Case: from generic finance app to debt/payment tracking workflow.

IF BUYER DIFFERS FROM USER

Split Personas

Separate user, buyer, operator, decision maker, and beneficiary before designing the next proof.

Case: hospital logistics buyer differs from patient beneficiary.

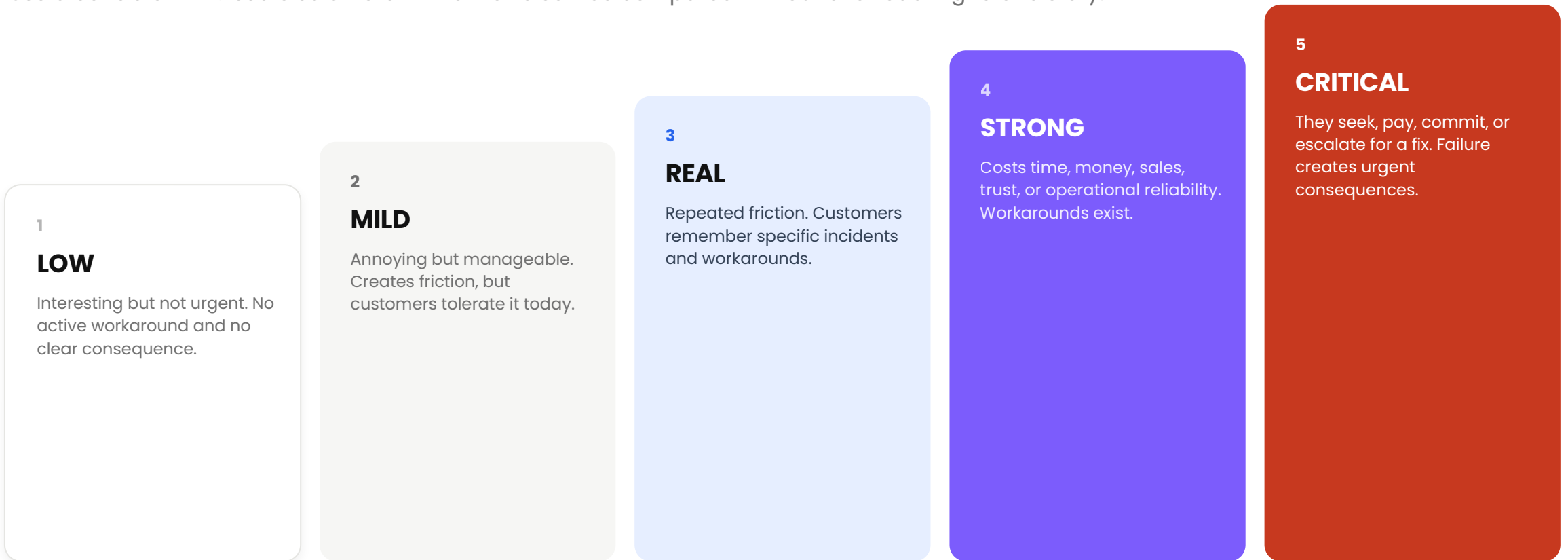
02 Interpret Pattern

Is the pain strong, weak, different, or owned by another buyer?

RULE Interviews are not a checklist; evidence must change the segment, problem, UVP, channel, or MVP / Product decision.

Pain Intensity Score

Use a consistent 1–5 scale so different interviews can be compared without overreacting to one story.



INTERPRETATION Scores 4–5 deserve MVP / Product tests first; scores 1–2 usually need narrower segmentation before building.

Paystack Discovery Logic

Payments were not a generic fintech idea.

CASE STUDY

Paystack

Read the case as a decision: what pain was real, what evidence mattered, and what can transfer to the team's own model?

01 Customer

Online merchants and developers who needed payment acceptance to work inside real checkout and business workflows.

02 Pain

Integration was slow, unreliable, and risky because failed payments directly blocked revenue.

03 Workaround

Manual bank processes, legacy payment systems, reconciliation work, and developer time spent patching payment flows.

04 Signal

A strong discovery signal is behavior: developers integrate, merchants transact, and failed payment reduction becomes measurable.

Next Session — Business Model Development & SDG

BM Development turns validated pain into a model that can create value, capture value, and show impact.